prisoners healthy, and many were at work. The hospital ship was cleaner and quieter than most of our county hospitals. Several convicts were lately come from the county gaols, and the captain justly observed, how different the health and complexion of such prisoners are now, from what they were when I first visited the hulks. But I must repeat my complaint, that such an assemblage is entirely destructive to the morals of young convicts: the profaneness of the prisoners is not properly checked; and some of the guards set them a bad example.

"26 March, 1787, the number of convicts was five hundred and forty-nine, of whom the *Justitia* had two hundred and forty-six, the *Censor* two hundred and twenty-nine, and the *Ceres* seventy-four. Of these thirty-six were in the hospital ship, eleven from the *Justitia*, twelve from the *Censor*, and thirteen from the *Ceres*.

"16 July, 1788, the number was seven hundred and forty-one. The *Justitia* had two hundred and sixty-five, the *Censor* two hundred and forty-eight, and the *Stanislaus* two hundred and twenty-eight.

"From the *Justitia* ninety, and from the *Stanislaus* one hundred and thirty-two, were at work on the shore, and in the ballast lighters.

"In the hospital ship were thirty-two; from the *Justitia* twelve, from the *Censor* twelve, and from the *Stanislaus* eight.

THE HULK AT PLYMOUTH

"10 November, 1787, the convicts at Plymouth dock were on board the hulk of the *Chatham*, a seventy-gun ship, and were healthy and well; but the *Dunkirk*, which is more commodious, was repairing for them. Their bread, beef, and beer were good; but the bread allowance of 4lb. a day to six men, is not sufficient. There were among them many fine young fellows, who all lived in total idleness, though some useful employment might here easily be found. There were ninety-two men and one woman: nine more convicts were coming on board from the gaol at Glamorgan.

"28 June, 1788, there were three hundred and sixty-six convicts in the *Dunkirk*, which was fitted up with several separate rooms. In one of the rooms, fifty-seven feet by eighteen, and six feet high, there were sixty-eight. Such a room, at night, when the hatches are down, must be very offensive. At one end, there is a room called the infirmary, and a recovery ward; in the former were seven convicts, and in the latter thirteen. The meat was sweet, but the bread not good, and the beer thick.

"The prisoners were all in total idleness, except six or seven who were making a boat for the captain. One ingenious man had made a small inkstand (which I have by me) out of a bone of his meat; but his knife was taken from him. I saw some with Bibles in their hands; but here is no chaplain, nor any religious service. Here also some of the keepers, by their profaneness, set a bad example to the prisoners.

"Three miserable objects, for attempting to break out, were let down into a dreadful, dark and deep hole at the bottom of the ship, where they lay, almost naked, upon a little straw; but, having been thus confined for some weeks, upon their earnest entreaties, I obtained their release.

THE HULK AT GOSPORT

"At Gosport, 7 July, 1788, there were two hundred and seventy-three convicts in the hulk of an old Indiaman, called the *Lion*, which was moored here 1 May, 1788. The ship was clean, and the prisoners had a healthy and placid look; but they lay two on a bed, with one blanket. Here were several to be transported for life, and some whose sentences were for a short term: among them were boys of only ten years of age. About one hundred and fifty of them were on shore, moving mould, who had irons on both legs, and a chain between them. Five carpenters were fitting up rooms for them to dine in, on shore; which is much better than returning at noon to the hulk, as the convicts do on the Thames.

THE HULKS NEAR PORTSMOUTH

"At Langston harbour, near Portsmouth, are three hulks. In *La Fortunée* (formerly a French thirty-six gun frigate) there were, 8 July, 1788, three hundred and thirty-eight convicts. In the *Ceres*, which was the receiving ship at Woolwich, and was brought round here 1 July, 1788, were two hundred and nineteen convicts. The other is an old hulk, now fitting up for a hospital ship. Two hundred and thirty of the convicts of the